India @ Cannes 2025

Yes, Aishwarya Rai Bachchan will turn heads with her annual red carpet appearance, but here are those who will fly India's flag high on the French Riviera



INDIAN TRIUMPH *All We Imagine As Light* won the Grand Prix at Cannes film festival last year

PAYAL KAPADIA

Cannes sure does love **Miss Kapadia**. After winning The Golden Eye for best documentary for *A Night of Knowing Nothing* (2021) and wowing the Greta Gerwig-led jury with her feature debut, *All We Imagine As Light* (2024), which awarded it the Grand Prix, the second biggest prize, Kapadia now switches sides to become a jury member. She joins the likes of jury president Isabelle Huppert, Oscar-winning actress Halle Berry, Korean filmmaker Hong Sang-soo, actor Jeremy Strong and others to watch the 21 films in the main competition and weigh in on the top awards. ■



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Neeraj Ghaywan



It has taken the **Masaan** filmmaker precisely a decade to make his sophomore feature. *Homebound*, much like *Masaan*, will have its world premiere on the croisette and will be a part of the *Un Certain Regard* line-up. Featuring Ishaan Khatter, Vishal Jethwa and Janhvi Kapoor, the Dharma Productions-helmed drama recently received a huge feather in its cap after American legend Martin Scorsese gave it his thumbs up by boarding as an executive producer. ■



Satyajit Ray Film & Television Institute

Kapadia's journey at Cannes began with La Cinef, a competitive sidebar that invites shorts from students. This time around, producer Sahil Manoj Ingle and writer-director **Kokob Gebrehaweria Tesfay**, an Ethiopian student at SRFTI, Kolkata, under the ICCR African scholarship, made the cut with *A Doll Made Up of Clay*. Billed as "a powerful exploration of displacement, loss, and cultural resilience", the 23-minute film follows a young Nigerian man (Ibrahim Ahmed) whose dream to play professional football in India crashes after he suffers a career-ending injury. ■

Compiled by Suhani Singh